

# Your own myFinance portal

A private finance app of your own — your database, your login, your web address. Claude does the technical part. You do six clicks.

## What you end up with

A website only you can sign into, that tracks what comes in, what goes out, what you own and owe, what you have agreed to pay, and what the next six months look like. It works on a phone. Nobody else can see it — not even the person who gave you this.

## Before you start

Three free accounts. Sign up for each now and the rest takes about twenty minutes.

|               |                                                                                                                       |
|---------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>GitHub</b> | github.com — where the code lives. Free.                                                                              |
| <b>Vercel</b> | vercel.com — puts it on the internet. Sign in <b>with GitHub</b> , it makes the next steps much easier. Free.         |
| <b>Claude</b> | claude.ai — does the technical work for you. A paid plan is needed for Claude Code, the version that can write files. |

### You do not need to know how to code.

You will not type a single line of it. Step 3 gives you a message to copy and paste — Claude reads the package, explains what it is doing, and asks you questions in plain English. Everything else in this guide is clicking buttons on a web page.

## What Claude does, and what you do

Worth knowing up front so nothing surprises you. Claude cannot log into your Vercel account — it has no password for it — so the part that puts the app online is yours. It is all clicking.

| Claude does                                                                                                                                                                                                                | You do                                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reads the package and explains it<br>Puts the code in your GitHub<br>Makes your secret password key<br>Names the app, sets your currency<br>Swaps in your own logo<br>Fixes anything that breaks<br>Answers every question | Create the three accounts<br>Click <b>New Project</b> in Vercel<br>Click <b>Create Database</b><br>Paste in two settings<br>Click <b>Deploy</b><br>Sign in and start using it |

## The six steps

1

### Save the package somewhere you can find it

You were sent a file called **strideup-finance-source.zip**. Put it on your Desktop and unzip it (double-click on a Mac; right-click > Extract All on Windows). You will get a folder called **strideup-finance**. Leave it there.

2

### Open Claude Code and point it at that folder

Claude Code is the version of Claude that can read and write files. Two ways to get it:

- **The app** — download Claude Code for Mac or Windows, open it, and choose the **strideup-finance** folder you just unzipped.
- **In a browser** — go to **claude.ai/code**. This one works from a GitHub repository rather than a folder, so ask Claude to do step 3 first and it will set the repository up for you.

Either is fine. The app is simpler if you already have the folder.

3

### Paste this message to Claude

This is the only thing you have to copy. Paste it exactly as it is and press enter.

```
I have been given the source code for a personal finance
web app and I want to set up my own private copy of it.

I am not a developer. Please read docs/your-own-copy.md and
docs/integration.md in this folder first, then walk me
through it one step at a time in plain English.

Please do these for me:
1. Put this code in a new private GitHub repository
   under my account.
2. Generate a strong SESSION_SECRET and tell me the
   exact settings I need to paste into Vercel.
3. Set it up for one person, personal use only.
4. Ask me what to call the app and which currency to
   use, then set those.

Stop and wait for me whenever you need me to click
something, and tell me exactly what to click.
```

Claude will ask you a few questions — what to call it, which currency, whether you want one set of books or two. Answer in normal words. It will then tell you when to move to step 4.

4

### Put it on the internet

Claude will have given you a GitHub repository and a short list of settings. Now:

1. Go to **vercel.com > Add New > Project**
2. Find your new repository in the list and click **Import**
3. Open **Environment Variables** and paste in the settings Claude gave you (there will be two: **SESSION\_SECRET** and **OWNER\_PASSWORD**)
4. Click **Deploy** and wait a minute or two

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## Add the database

This is where your figures are kept. Vercel sets it up for you.

1. In your new project, open the **Storage** tab
2. Click **Create Database** and choose **Neon** (Postgres)
3. Accept the free plan and connect it to this project
4. Go to **Deployments** and click **Redeploy** on the newest one

You do not have to copy any database settings across — connecting it is enough. The app finds it by itself.

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## Sign in

Open the web address Vercel gives you. Sign in with your email and the `OWNER_PASSWORD` you chose in step 4.

That is it. It is live, it is yours, and nobody else has the password.

**On your phone:** open the same address in your phone's browser, then add it to your home screen (Safari: Share > Add to Home Screen. Chrome: menu > Add to Home screen). It then opens like an app.

## If something goes wrong

Tell Claude. It has the whole codebase in front of it and a troubleshooting section in **docs/your-own-copy.md**. Paste in whatever the screen says — the error message is the useful part. These three are the common ones:

### The page says something is missing

Open **/api/health** after your web address. It lists exactly what is not set yet, in plain words. Show that to Claude.

### You cannot sign in

The password is whatever you put in `OWNER_PASSWORD`. Change it in Vercel > Settings > Environment Variables and redeploy — that resets it.

### It deployed but looks broken

Almost always the database step. Check **Storage** shows a connected database, then redeploy.

## Changing things later

You do not have to get everything right now. Anything here can be changed afterwards by asking Claude, or by editing one setting in Vercel and redeploying.

|                                       |                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Its name</b>                       | FINANCE_APP_NAME                                                                                                   |
| <b>Your currency</b>                  | FINANCE_BASE_CURRENCY — <b>decide this early</b> . Changing it later re-does every past figure.                    |
| <b>Your logo</b>                      | Replace the picture files in <code>client/public/</code> , or ask Claude to do it                                  |
| <b>Your name and photo</b>            | Change them inside the app, under <b>My profile</b>                                                                |
| <b>Reading invoices automatically</b> | Add an ANTHROPIC_API_KEY from console.anthropic.com. Optional and paid — <b>everything else works without it</b> . |

## Two things to know before you rely on it

### It is for one person.

One login, one set of books. There is no way to add a second person to your copy — if someone else wants their own, they follow this guide and get their own. That is deliberate: it is why nobody can see your figures.

### It is not connected to your bank.

Nothing arrives by itself. You record what happened — by typing it in, or by uploading a bill or invoice and letting the app read it. The figures it shows are the ones you put in, which is why they are always explainable.

## Your data is yours

Your own database, in your own account. The person who gave you this cannot see it, and neither can anyone else without your password. There is an **Export** button on every page that gives you a spreadsheet of everything, any time. You are never locked in.

## The links, in one place

|                              |                                                |
|------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| <b>github.com</b>            | Where your copy of the code lives              |
| <b>vercel.com</b>            | Where it runs. Sign in with GitHub.            |
| <b>claude.ai/code</b>        | Claude Code in a browser                       |
| <b>console.anthropic.com</b> | Only if you want invoice reading               |
| <b>docs/your-own-copy.md</b> | The longer written version, inside the package |
| <b>docs/integration.md</b>   | For a developer, if you hand it to one         |

Built with Claude Code. If you get stuck, the fastest thing you can do is paste the error into Claude and ask what it means — it can see the whole app and will usually fix it for you.